

PRELUDE IX

THIS Prelude was at one time used by Bach as a Prelude to the Sixth French Suite. It is in very clear melodic binary form, bars 1-8 being recapitulated a fifth lower in bars 15-22. The modulation in bar 6, and the chromatic passage in bars 7-8, show that the *tempo* must not hurry their delicate expression, while bar 14 will show the danger of dragging. The right *tempo* reconciles the claims of both passages, with the aid of a reasonable freedom of rhythm.

The trill in bar 4 may end on either the fourth quaver or the sixth. The sign ω may also be read as a trill, though the usual short reading of three notes (beginning with the upper note ) is best here, and is preferred by Kroll.

FUGUE IX

IN this Fughetta it is not worth while settling where the Subject ends and where the Counter-subject begins. There need be no doubt where the quaver and crotchet mark the beginning of the Subject, though already the Answer in bar 2 (beginning with a unison) demands technical care to bring out the quaver. The clearest method is always to detach the quaver from the crotchet and to mark both. If this is done, and if thereafter most of the quavers throughout the Fugue are detached, growing suspicions of other witty allusions to the theme will arise which will become a delightful certainty in bar 27, near the end of the Fugue, where Bach's afterthought (unaccountably rejected by Bischoff, though it is the kind of thing nobody but Bach carries through) turns the bass, from what was first written as a mere descending scale, into four distinct allusions to the main figure. A similar reading in the last part of bar 24 (A, E, F#, C#, instead of the scale) is less well vouched for, and might weaken the effect of bar 27, being harmonically in the same position.

Certain quavers require a singing *legato*, notably in the Episode of bars 17-19 and the suspensions in bars 11-12. On the other hand, the episodic quaver figure in bars 5-6 should be clearly detached and recognisable wherever it recurs, as in bars 12, 21, and 26. The most important Episode is that in bars 13-15, where the suspended crotchets must sing well; likewise when they recur in the treble in bars 22½-24, answered finally in the bass of bars 25-26. The subtle entry of the Subject without its initial quaver in bar 20 must be given with an enthusiastic swell in the uprushing semiquavers. Nothing could be worse than the pedantry which substitutes an ordinary entry there, as in early printed versions.

The *tempo* is as lively as clearness permits.

A. B. 99.